Water as Leverage
For Resilient Cities

Multilevel Climate Action Programme

Water should not only be seen as a challenge but needs to be embraced as an opportunity and solution. The **Water as Leverage Multilevel Climate Action Programme** (WaL-MCAP) builds on this idea through an **inclusive design-driven approach** that develops, finances and implements projects across sectoral and administrative boundaries. It supports the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), the objectives of the Paris Agreement and the New Urban Agenda (NUA). The programme is structured around the Water as Leverage (WaL) framework, which comprises **three interconnected pillars, eight principles** and a **six-stage urban development project life cycle**.

WaL Pillars

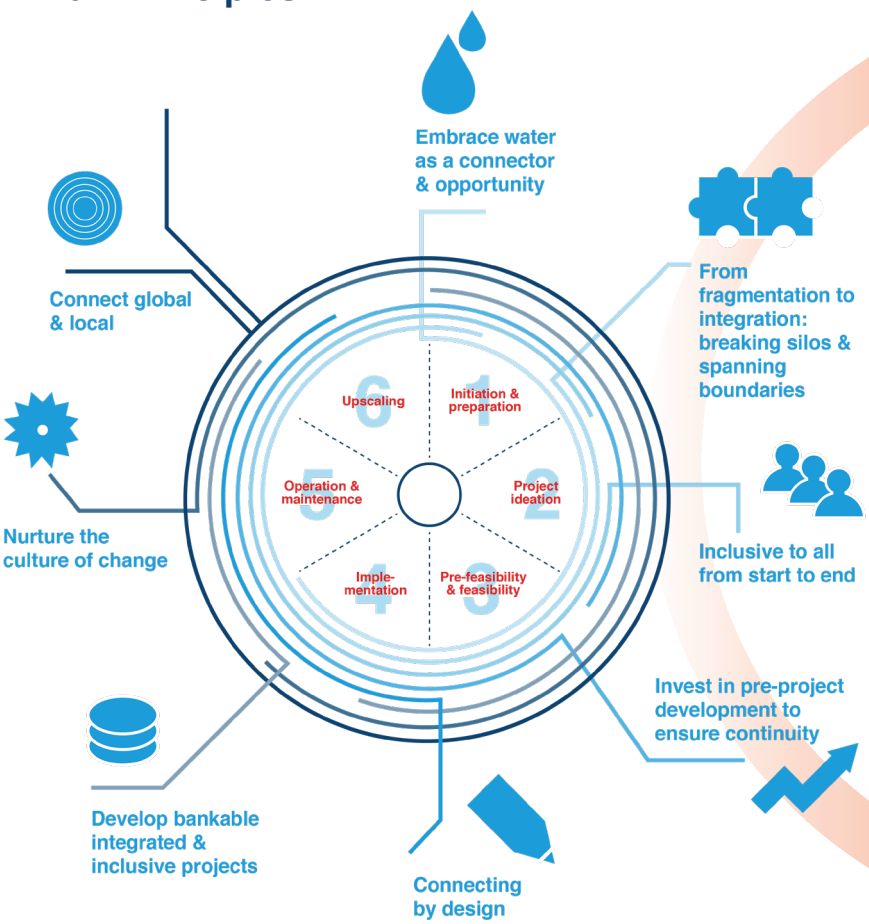
The Academy

A platform for urban practitioners and local governments to co-produce knowledge, conduct research, raise awareness and build capacity on the critical role of water in climate resilience and urban development through training modules, city-to-city learning sessions, and online knowledge sharing events.

The Factory

A global and local network of urban water hubs where the skills and expertise of partners come together to provide technical support for integrating water into multilevel frameworks and plans, conducting multi-scale finance strategies and implementing WaL initiatives.

WaL Principles



The Initiatives

Local integrated, inclusive and financeable urban water resilience projects that are facilitated by WaL's provision of knowledge (Academy) and technical support (Factory) throughout the following **six-stage urban development project life cycle**:

1	2	3	4	5	6
Initiation & preparation	Project ideation	Pre-feasibility & feasibility	Imple-mentation	Operation & maintenance	Upscaling

Scaling Up

Building on experiences and successes of WaL for resilient cities in Asia and, responding to the growing need for urban climate resilience worldwide, the programme aims to scale up and expand its impact across cities in Latin America, Africa, the Middle East, Europe and Central Asia to achieve a significant global impact.

As a result, the WaL-MCAP emerged from a partnership between UN-Habitat and the Netherlands Enterprise & Development Agency (RVO) to increase the number of initiatives in cities, countries and regions, by providing technical assistance, with the support of Deltares, and developing opportunities for knowledge sharing and peer-to-peer learning.

How to partner with us?

WaL-MCAP is seeking partnerships for knowledge creation and sharing (The Academy), technical support to initiatives (The Factory), and funding for the development of initiatives and up scaling the programme.

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For more information, visit the WaL website!

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